

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Gaming

Real-life heroes are few and far between, but in the gaming world, anyone can be a one. But how do you *sound* like one? Listen to Our Hero's story: He sauntered into the dark and sinister-looking dungeon with the nonchalance of a two-year old who couldn't have known better. Not surprisingly, he soon found himself *Fragged*—finished by the enemy, leaving him a useless, lifeless lump of virtual human flesh. This was no ordinary enemy, either—it was a dreaded *Camper*, who springs out of the underbrush and *tags* his unsuspecting prey. Life isn't a ball in the world of the *First Person Shooter (FPS)*.

Retiring from the world of active warfare, our hero decides to build his army and enter the world of the *Real-time Strategy (RTS) Game*, commandeering his forces to wreak havoc on his enemies' bases, while he looks upon them from a safe location.

Every once in a while, though, The Itch strikes, and he wants to feel the heat of battle once again—but not without his forces. So, in the *Tactical FPS*, he gets to kill some bad guys himself, and also seek his team's help in tight spots.

For an "out of body" experience, he turns to the *Role Playing Game (RPG)*, putting himself in some one else's shoes. He will now fight evil, or embark upon an *Adventure Game*, full of cryptic clues and mythical monsters and other such hindrances to progress.

Not content with interacting with artificially-intelligent *bots*, Our Hero decides to go online and take on the world of the *Massively Multiplayer Online RPG*, where he can interact and with other players from all over the world, brought together as a huge online civilisation.

And if boredom sets in, there is always the joy of the *Arcade Racer*—there are few things more fun than spreading a few hundred thousand dollars worth of car all over the landscape.

They're Out To Get Us!

It's been a month of terror, questionable odours and infighting here this month.

Digit's Enemy No. 1 reared its ugly head again, as we saw several of us succumbing to upset bellies and other gastronomic disasters. Ram was the first casualty, closely followed by Raaabo, who clearly underestimated the power of a wayward mushroom. Towards the middle of the month, Nimish, too, teetered on the edge, but was saved by an Unnamed Force.

And so, we've decided to invite readers who have respectable cooking skills and who value our safety to find it in their hearts to send us some good, wholesome food.

In-team tensions reached an all-time high as the Test Centre took what seems to be a blood-oath not to allow the cool new speakers into the editorial area. A stalemate has been reached, with Sanket steadfastly holding his ground

and Raaabo's less than substantial form uselessly (but relentlessly) trying to get past him.

We're no strangers to fighting over game reviews, but you know it's a slow month when we have people fighting *not* to do them. The gist of the matter was:

Raaabo: Ugh... you do this one.

Nimish: No, you do it.

Raaabo: No, you do it.

Nimish: YOU!!!

(Time wears on...)

Raaabo: I'm too busy. You'll need to do both.

Nimish: (drops unconscious in horror)

All worked out in the end, though.

On the good-news side, Brother Zivalal witnessed a new addition to his family—a little baby girl. Justifiably, he vamoosed for the rest of the month, leaving Vijay trembling at the prospect of doing the work of two men.

Makes you wonder how we ever got this issue out, doesn't it?

DIGIT DIARY

helped instead by their obvious glow.

We're also hoping for some glow-pets to keep us company on those dark nights. Or when the time comes to scare someone with a strategically placed cat in a haunted house.

IPRIEST

Preaching The Way Of The iPod

We all expected this. There is no escaping the insane popularity of the wondrous little iPods. We've built shrines for them, made clothing especially to accommodate them, pretty much let our lives revolve around them.

In a very smart-arsed move, a pastor in Houston, Texas has used the iPod to draw more people into churches and listen to the Word of God. The little marvel, he claims, teaches us a very valuable lesson—life can be simple, too. In praising the ease of use of

the iPod's user interface, Pastor Sal Sberna has given iPod worshippers the ultimate justification for their madness—it was made the way the Good Lord intended it.

"All you do on the outside is push the little button, drive the wheel and pick what usefulness you want out of your iPod," he says. "And so when Jesus talks to us about simplification, it must start on the inside."

We're tempted to start an "Innovative use of iPod" award just to felicitate the good Man of the Cloth.

CHATROOM CRYBABY

Watch Who You Tease

George Gillespie, a resident of Ohio in the USA, claims he was shamed by two men in a chat-room, and has sued them for emotional distress. He has also filed a suit against America Online (AOL) for failing to intervene and stop the humiliation. The men were



supposedly teasing Gillespie in the chat. Many stories abound, including one where one of the two 'perpetrators' travelled to Ohio to hand in a change-of-address form to the local Post Office, having them redirect Gillespie's mail to a different location.

Mike Marlowe of Alabama and Bob Charpentier of Oregon, the accused, have wasted no time registering their shock at this development. "I'm so flabbergasted with this because this has been blown out of proportion," Marlowe told Law.com.